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Budding Entrepreneurs Forum

FEBURARY, 2025

VENTURES VOYAGE

ENTREPRENEURS

Passion turns side hustles into legacies—one bold step at a time.

Dream, dare, and transform your ambition into a thriving reality.

"Every great venture begins as a tiny spark of ambition—nurtured with passion, courage, and resilience, it transforms from a side hustle into a fulfilling journey of entrepreneurship."

INTRODUCTION

Numerous individuals find themselves juggling a second career alongside their regular duties coinciding with each other. Picture a chef tweaking a recipe or an architect constructing a design in the night silence. These endeavours are sparks generated from a tiny ambition with great determination. Sometimes those started with a habit can be delved into a beautiful passionate career. Every galaxy is made up of tiny stars, and the many little ideas give rise to startups.

The process of making a second career to a full-time business is an exciting and very uncertain process. It is about taking risks by conviction that an individual's passion drives. Carefully preparing, fortitude and openness towards uncertainty celebrate the transition from the hustle to a full-time career journey. Creating a life that fits your goals and values is more important than simply creating enough money.

We will honour the experience of people who have made this jump into an investigation, emphasizing the difficulties they encountered and their success. Let us explore the core of entrepreneurship with us, as well as life life-changing potential of doing what an individual loves.

Garima Prasad
FY-MBA BFS

CHUMBAK: EVOLUTION FROM A SIDE BUSINESS TO A GLOBAL LIFESTYLE BRAND:

Chumbak is an example of the evolution of a side business into a successful brand. In 2010 Vivek Prabhakar & Shubhra Chadda started Chumbak with a capital of 45 lakhs while managing their corporate jobs. Identifying a gap in the souvenir market, they started with India-specific souvenirs like fridge magnets.

The company's vibrant, modern designs soon attracted success, and by 2013, it had diversified into fashion, home decor, and accessories. Instead of taking the traditional retail route, the promoters shifted to e-commerce and successfully built a strong customer base by strategically utilizing social media platforms. The first store was launched in Bengaluru, which soon pushed Chumbak to become a national brand.

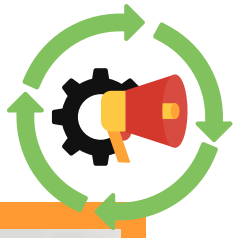
Chumbak evolved from its early days of specializing in travel souvenirs to become an international lifestyle brand that takes a holistic approach. The strategy of blending Indian cultural elements with modern design principles is a major contributor to enabling them to stand out in the market. Today, Chumbak has several retail stores and a massive online presence and has made grand entry into international markets.

Nishant Inamdar
MBA FY - IB

MAILCHIMP: TWO FOUNDERS BUILT A BOOTSTRAPPED SUCCESS

Mailchimp is a top email marketing company in the world, and it first started out as a small side project. It was established in 2001 by Ben Chestnut and Dan Kurzius. Actually, Mailchimp initially started out to help small companies manage email campaigns. Both of the founders were actually operating a web design firm named The Rocket Science Group at that time. They simply did the side project for their clients on email marketing.

Chestnut and Kurzius developed MailChimp for nearly six years while operating their agency. The platform started booming as companies started requiring simple email marketing tools. By 2007, demand had increased immensely, and the founders chose to close down their web design firm to work on Mailchimp completely. From there on, the transition revolutionized Mailchimp into a behemoth in the space of email marketing.



The most important factor that distinguished Mailchimp was its approachable interface and affordability. It enabled small businesses to be at par with the big companies in online marketing. Mailchimp eventually diversified into automation CRM and social media features.

Today, Mailchimp is a multi-million-dollar business, testament to how a side gig can turn into a business-changing company with the right vision and hard work.

Samiksha Pazare
FY MBA Finance

TURNING HOBBIES INTO MAIN GIGS

Etsy transformed the creative entrepreneurial space for artisans by being a virtual storefront to sell their vintage, handmade artwork and goods . Chris Maguire and Rob Kalin worked on this idea in their Brooklyn apartment and the initial version of the etsy inc. took about two and a half months to build and turn it into reality. Etsy kicked off as an e-commerce platform enabling individuals to sell their handmade products and art from the comfort of their own homes.

Etsy started off as an idea blooming in the minds of Chris and Rob as they provided a platform to artisans struggling with their artwork to showcase their art while having monetary gains. Etsy business model gained recognition as the digital era rolled in.

The business model of Etsy is where people can turn their creative craftsmanship into full time business. Etsy transitioned to a fully cloud-based infrastructure in 2019, leveraging the digitalization era into making their business a capital and profitable business.

Initially Etsy faced challenges while turning into a full time operation ; such as financial security of sellers and income volatility. Hiring of clients was a concern while managing the inconsistent revenue. Etsy was a dream come true for artists as it became a bridge between the buyer and the artist.

Etsy when switched itself to full time operation was working on a no profit basis where they resolved issues of the sellers who came to their platforms. Recently, Etsy introduced a centralized seller's hub to streamline inventory management and provide easier access to tools and services.

The Etsy business model is a perfect blend of entrepreneurial spirit and strategic platform evolution. While being a business itself, it provides budding entrepreneurs a platform to turn their creativity into a full time operating business. Etsy's dream of turning individuals side hustles into main gigs is now every budding entrepreneur's stepping stone in the journey of the unknown.

Sanjana Kashyap
MBA FY HR

FROM A SIDE HUSTLE TO A FOOD-TECH GIANT

Zomato, one of the biggest food delivery and restaurant discovery platforms in India, was started as a side hustle. In 2008, Deepinder Goyal and Pankaj Chaddah, who were both working with Bain & Company, noticed the pain their colleagues were facing in finding restaurant menus. To solve this, they started "Foodiebay," a website where they would scan and upload menus from restaurants in the vicinity.

At first, it was just a simple phone directory, but its acceptance grew as users found it convenient. Seeing the opportunity, the founders resigned from their jobs to devote themselves to it full-time. In 2010, it was officially renamed Zomato and expanded from simply listing menus to restaurant reviews and ratings and eventually, food delivery.

Zomato scaled fast with investments coming from the world over, such as Info Edge and Sequoia Capital. It internationalized and introduced innovations including cloud kitchens, subscription services and contactless dining. In the year 2021, Zomato went public, crowning a rare moment in the Indian startup ecosystem.

What began as a side project morphed into a multi-billion-dollar company, changing the way food discovery and delivery is done in India and beyond.

Zomato's story is a testimony to the fact that the innovative solution can soar into a disruptive business if buoyed by vision and execution.

Manali Khadilkar
FY-MBA HR

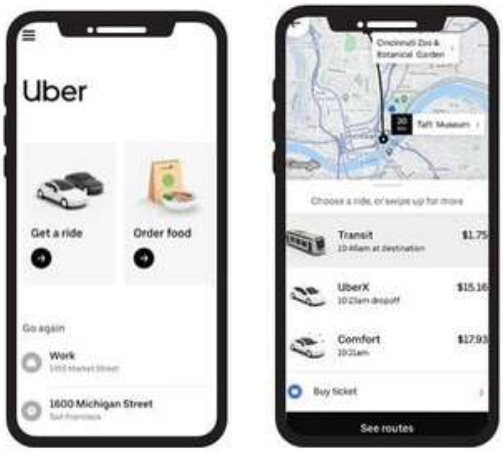
zomato

UBER'S EVOLUTION EXEMPLIFIES THE TRANSFORMATIVE POWER OF INNOVATION AND ADAPTABILITY

Uber's journey, from being just a small startup to a transport giant in the world, reflects the strength of innovative thinking. Founded in 2009 by Garrett Camp and Travis Kalanick, it started off under the name of UberCab- an idea meant to make transport in urban settings easier through application on smartphones where users can send requests for getting rides. Uber started in San Francisco initially offering premium black car services, it realized a need for cheaper options. This paved the way for UberX in 2012, enabling any regular commuter to utilize the private vehicle he or she is using for carpooling purposes. The former cut the prices for the user and at the same time, also opened an extra source of earnings for drivers which, consequently resulted in the strong growth.

In 2011, it received Series A funding for the amount of $11 million; then $32 million for Series B was acquired later that year. These investments allowed Uber to expand into new markets and diversify its services. Throughout its lifetime, Uber expanded beyond ride-hailing. Uber Eats was a creation that served the food delivery market, while others like Uber Freight targeted logistics and freight transport. By 2023, Uber was operating in about 70 countries and 10,500 cities arranging about 28 million trips daily. This story of Uber epitomizes the transformation of an idea into revolutionizing an entire industry, the role of flexibility and strategic expansion in achieving a global reach.

Uber



Sushmita Poojari ,
FY MBA FINANCE

THE JOURNEY OF ATOM.COM : FROM SIDE HUSTLE TO FULL TIME HUSTLE

In 2011, the founder of Atom.com (formerly Squadhelp) Darpan Munjal, founder and CEO of Atom, the AI-powered startup ecosystem, faced a challenge, naming a business. To solve this, they launched a contest online, offering a small reward for the best name "on its way to becoming the go-to naming and branding destination.

The success of this idea sparked a realization: many entrepreneurs struggle to find the right name for their businesses. This led to the creation of a platform where businesses could crowdsource names from creative individuals.

The first customer arrived within two days, and within three months, revenue reached $2,000 per month. However, balancing this side hustle with another business was a challenge. With growing demand, the founder hired tech and customer support professionals, eventually taking the business full-time after three and a half years.

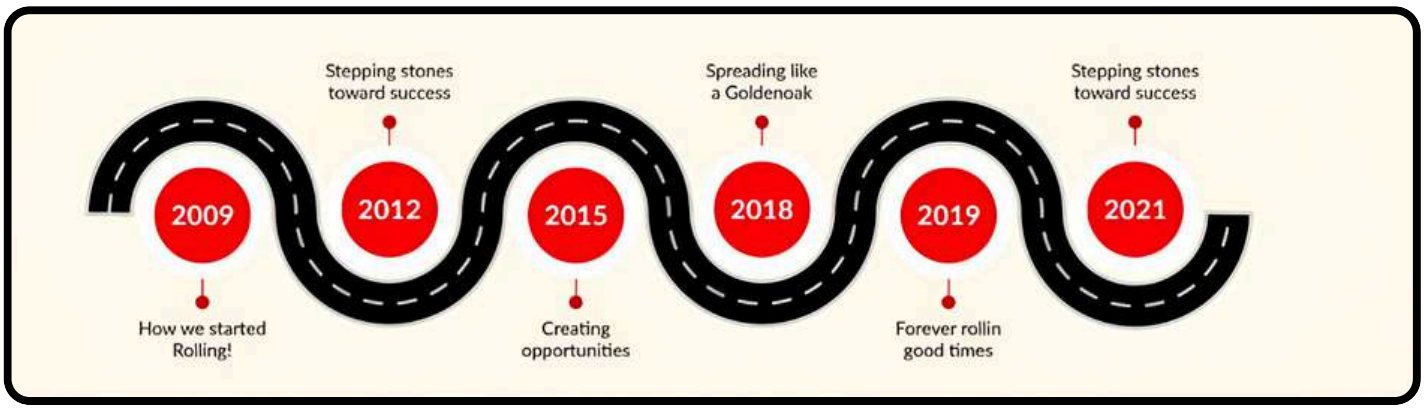
Today, Atom.com is a thriving startup ecosystem, helping over 50,000 clients, including brands like Pepsi and Nestlé. The secret to success? Continuous innovation, adapting to customer feedback, and understanding the fundamentals of business. What started as a simple naming contest is now a multimillion-dollar platform offering branding solutions to businesses worldwide. Atom.com proves that with persistence, creativity, and the right strategy, a small idea can grow into something extraordinary.

Priyanka Nagar
FY-MBA IB

FROM A HUMBLE KIOSK TO A NATIONWIDE EMPIRE: THE ROLLS MANIA STORY

In 2009, an 18-year-old with a dream and a mere Rs 20,000 in his pocket arrived in Pune. Puneet Kansal had no formal experience in the food and beverage industry, but he carried an unshakable belief in his idea. He set up a small kiosk outside a restaurant in Magarpatta City, selling kathi rolls—simple, yet delicious. What started as a table-sized venture with one chef soon attracted a loyal customer base.

Among these customers were Gagan and Sukhpreet Sial, two entrepreneurs in the restaurant business who saw immense potential in Puneet's vision. Their shared passion led to the formal establishment of Rolls Mania in 2010. Together, they expanded from a single outlet to a thriving business model built on quality, quantity, and quick service.



Over the years, Rolls Mania evolved into a powerhouse, clocking over five lakh roll sales per month and establishing a robust franchise model with over 100 outlets across 30 cities. Their success was driven by an unwavering commitment to consistency, with central control over spices and standardized recipes ensuring the same delectable taste across all locations.

Beyond business, their impact extended to empowering entrepreneurs —70% of their franchise owners are women. Today, Rolls Mania is poised for international expansion, venturing into the Middle East and beyond.

Puneet Kansal's journey from a struggling young entrepreneur to the leader of a Rs 35-crore empire is a testament to resilience, vision, and the power of unwavering belief. His story serves as an inspiration to every aspiring entrepreneur with a dream and the courage to pursue it.

Rolls Mania®

Yash Mutha
FY-MBA FINANCE

SUCCESS STORIES

1. Spanx—Sara Blakely

Setback: Sara Blakely worked as a door-to-door fax machine salesperson, facing constant rejection. She had no background in fashion and struggled to find manufacturers who would take her seriously.

Comeback: Using her $5,000 savings, she persisted, finally convincing a hosiery mill to produce her product. Oprah Winfrey's endorsement catapulted Spanx to fame, and today, it's a billion-dollar brand.

SPANX®
BY SARA BLAKELY®

2. Under Armour—Kevin Plank

Setback: While playing football, Plank noticed how sweat-soaked cotton shirts affected performance. He started designing a moisture-wicking alternative but struggled to gain traction.

Comeback: He used his savings and credit cards to fund the business, personally delivering shirts to college teams. His breakthrough came when Georgia Tech and NFL teams adopted the gear, leading to a multi-billion-dollar empire.

UNDER ARMOUR

3. Airbnb—Brian Chesky & Joe Gebbia

Setback: They started Airbnb by renting out an air mattress in their apartment. The investors rejected the idea, leaving them overwhelmed by debt.

Comeback: They sold novelty cereal boxes ("Obama O's") to raise funds, kept refining the platform, and eventually attracted investors. Today, Airbnb is a global hospitality disruptor worth billions.

4. WhatsApp—Jan Koum & Brian Acton

Setback:

Jan Koum and Brian Acton, former Yahoo employees, applied for jobs at Facebook but were rejected. Koum started WhatsApp as a side project, but the early versions kept crashing, and user adoption was slow.

Comeback:

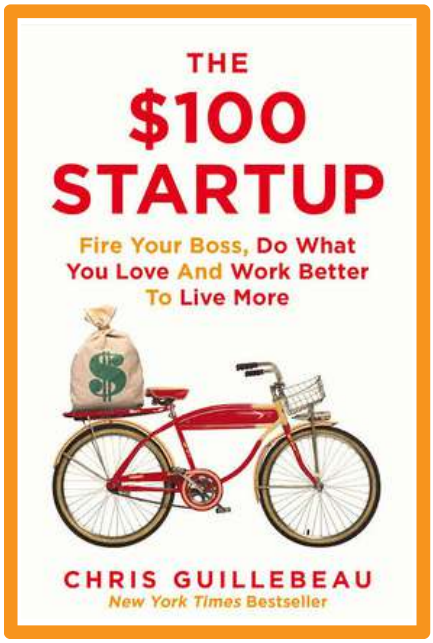
Instead of giving up, they refined the app, focusing on simplicity and a no-ads policy. Word-of-mouth growth skyrocketed its popularity, leading to a $19 billion acquisition by Facebook—one of the biggest tech deals in history.

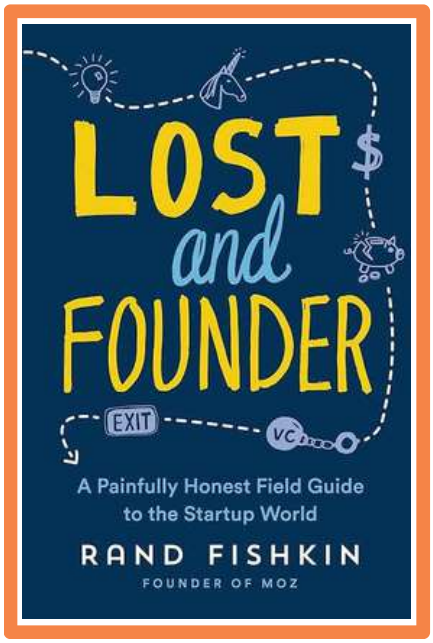
Harsha Saraf
FY-MBA Finance

SUGGESTION BOX

1. **The 100$ Startup by Chris Guillebeau** - A practical guide to launching a profitable business with minimal funds, using skills for independence.
2. **Lost and Founder by Rand Fishkin** - A candid guide to startup challenges, debunking myths and sharing real lessons from entrepreneurship.

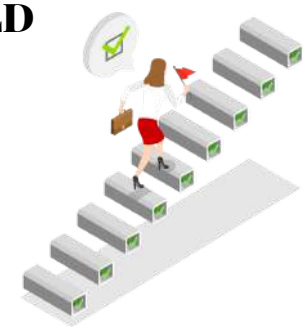
1. **Side Hustle** - Start a Side Business Course Hosted on Fiverr Learn-: A practical course on launching and growing a profitable side business with minimal investment.
2. **Side Hustle to Self Employed** – Skillshare :Covers mindset shifts, business models, and action steps to go full-time.





Tanaya Zad
MBA FY Finance

WHAT'S HAPPENING
IN THE ENTREPRENEURSHIP WORLD



CES 2025
Date: January 6-9, 2025
Location: Las Vegas, USA

Consumer Electronics Show 2025 is an annual trade show organized by the Consumer Technology Association. The event typically hosts presentations of new products and technologies in the consumer electronics industry where brands get business done, meet new partners and where the industry's sharpest minds take the stage to unveil their latest groundbreaking innovation. The event featured keynote speeches from industry giants, panel discussions on emerging trends and networking opportunities with investors and tech enthusiasts.

TiE Global Summit 2025
Date: January 10-12, 2025
Location: Hyderabad, India

The TiE Global Summit 2025 brought together entrepreneurs, investors and industry leaders from around the world. The event featured panel discussions, networking sessions and speeches. Topics covered included scaling startups, investment strategies and the future of technology. The summit also hosted a startup expo where emerging companies showcased their innovative products and solutions.

WHAT'S HAPPENING
IN THE ENTREPRENEURSHIP WORLD

National Startup Day 2025
Date: January 16, 2025
Location: Nationwide

National Startup Day 2025 celebrated the ninth anniversary of the Startup India initiative. It honors the spirit of entrepreneurship and the contributions of startups to India's economy. It encourages young minds to think about possibilities, creativity and play an active role in national progress. India has firmly established itself as the third largest startup ecosystem in the world with more than 1.59 lakh startups recognised by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade.

Manipal Entrepreneurship Summit 2025
Date: January 27-29, 2025
Location: Manipal, India

The Manipal Entrepreneurship Summit 2025 ignited the entrepreneurial spark in India's youth. Here, the keynote speakers were Dr. Arokiaswamy Velumani, founder of Thyrocare and Ashneer Grover who shared their entrepreneurial journeys. The summit featured an 'Innovation Mela' showcasing over 120 startups, a DeepTech Conclave on transformative technologies and a Pitch Tank competition. Attendees gained valuable insights and opportunities to connect with industry leaders and investors.

WHAT'S HAPPENING
IN THE ENTREPRENEURSHIP WORLD

Startup Grind Global Conference 2025
Date: January 22-24, 2025
Location: Redwood City, USA

The Startup Grind Global Conference 2025 brought together entrepreneurs, investors and thought leaders to discuss the future of startups. The event featured workshops on scaling businesses, fireside chats with successful founders and startup exhibitions. The conference emphasized the importance of community and collaboration in the startup ecosystem. Attendees had a valuable opportunity to present their ideas to leading venture capitalists and gain meaningful insights from industry experts.

KRISHNA GUTTE
FY MBA HR B

CROSSING BORDERS: A JOURNEY OF CULTURE, INNOVATION, AND LEARNING—INDIA X SPAIN

Education is no longer just about books and lectures—it's about experiences that shape us. A student from Mondragon University, Spain, recently shared how traveling across different countries transformed their perspective. "That's what I was missing," they realized, as they embraced the power of global exposure in shaping both personal and professional growth.

One of the most unique aspects of their education was compulsory adventures—an opportunity to explore the world while learning. They spent one and a half months in Berlin, another one and a half in New York, and two months in Seoul, South Korea. These experiences taught them lessons that no textbook ever could.
But this journey was about more than just academics—it was about self-discovery. As an entrepreneur, they weren't just focused on building a business; they were focused on building themselves.
"Step away from the people around you. Travel alone. Find out who you really are. Then choose who you want to be with."

This story is a reminder that growth happens outside our comfort zones. It's an invitation to explore, learn, and most importantly, find ourselves.

Host-Sohira Kshemkalyani

RIDDLES

Questions

1. I was once a secret after-hours game; now the world knows my name. **What am I?**
2. I existed between shifts and breaks; now I run without those stakes. **What am I?**
3. I started as a fun escape; now I shape my owner's fate. **What am I?**
4. A hobby, a gig, a passion in disguise—now I am my owner's prize. **What am I?**
5. I was built on free time and late nights; now I shine in broad daylight. **What am I?**
6. I lived in garages and coffee shops first; now I quench an empire's thirst. **What am I?**
7. I grew from an unplanned idea; now I have offices across the land. **What am I?**
8. Once a side road, now the main street, I turn struggles into a feat. **What am I?**
9. I was a test, a trial, a dare—now I lead with profits to spare. **What am I?**
10. I was Plan B when times were tough, but soon Plan A wasn't enough. **What am I?**

Answers

1. Startup
2. Business
3. Venture
4. Enterprise
5. Company
6. Brand
7. Corporation
8. Career
9. Success
10. Entrepreneurship

Ishika Jangra
FY-MBA HR

CONCLUSION

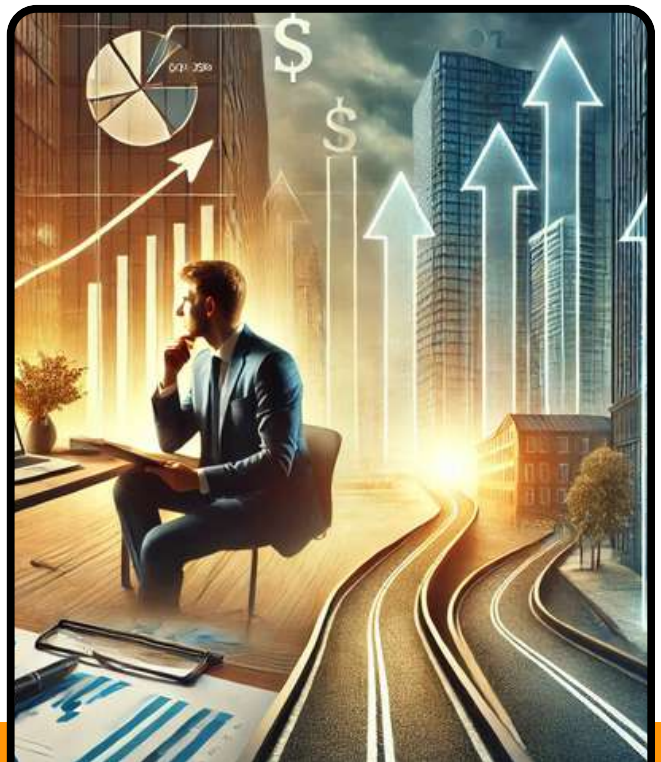
The moment of giving up your side hustle and taking on a full-time job is stressful because it requires planning and determination, as well as financial security. Investors should consider the company's profitability, business needs, and growth before forming an investment agreement.

You can also limit risk along the way by building a strong customer base, generating more revenue, and managing emergency funds. The transition from part-time to full-time also requires long-term thinking and education. Businesspeople need to improve, refine, and establish stability in order to achieve growth.

In times of drought, feedback and guidance from people in your community can be very useful. Many successful entrepreneurs, founders, and business owners choose to reinvest their earnings, raise capital from outside, or sign bonds to fund their projects. Full-time, part-time before retirement.

After all, in these situations, good strategy, patience, and the ability to change the flow of thought are the most important things. If these entrepreneurs can develop profitable business ideas and solutions to business problems and are willing to learn new skills, these efforts can scale to good results and long-term collaboration

Saanya Nair
FY-MBA Finance



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